

To figure out how much we'll need to set aside, we estimate how many events we think we might go to in a year. I take the amount we would normally spend for such an event (multiplied by how many events I assume we'll be going to), and add that to my final birthday and Christmas spending totals. Then I take that yearly amount, and divide it according to our bi-weekly paycheck schedule.

Here's an example:

- 2 Weddings (\$25 gift each) = \$50
- 3 Showers (\$20 gift each) = \$60
- 2 Grad Parties (\$15 gift each) = \$30
- Birthdays = \$200
- Christmas = \$400

**TOTAL SPENDING = \$740/Year**

$\$740/26 \text{ (Bi-Weekly Paychecks)} = \$28.46$

So, I need to set aside approximately **\$29** every paycheck to adequately cover all gift-related spending for the year.

Your estimates will probably be completely different from mine, and you may have to adjust it every year, but at least you will have a little extra money set aside so you're not caught completely off guard!

## 2. BE REGISTRY SAVVY

Gift registries can be such a lifesaver when shopping for the soon-to-be mom or bride. Instead of wondering what they want or need, you know exactly what's on their wish list. But sometimes, this wish list is filled with items well above your budget.